

UNIT 4 / Build your sentences

Say no clearly

Your goal: Distinguish nicht from kein in basic sentences.

01 Learn the idea

Use kein to negate an indefinite noun or a noun without an article: Ich habe kein Auto. Use nicht to negate adjectives, verbs or specific parts of a sentence: Ich bin nicht müde; ich wohne nicht in Berlin. The choice depends on what you are negating, not simply on the English word not.

Nicht often comes after a simple verb phrase, but before the adjective or location it negates. Learn short patterns first: Das ist nicht teuer. Ich komme nicht. Keine is used with a feminine noun or basic plural nouns. Read the entire statement to see whether it denies an object, a quality or an action.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich habe kein Auto.	I do not have a car.
Das ist nicht teuer.	That is not expensive.
Ich bin nicht müde.	I am not tired.
Wir haben keine Zeit.	We do not have time.
Ich komme nicht.	I am not coming.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Hast du ein Auto?

Do you have a car?

Mia

Nein, ich habe kein Auto. Ich fahre mit dem Bus.

No, I do not have a car. I travel by bus.

Ben

Ist das teuer?

Is that expensive?

Mia

Nein, das ist nicht teuer.

No, that is not expensive.

Your real-life mission

Negate these statements: Ich habe ein Auto. Das ist teuer. Ich bin müde. Wir haben Zeit. Read the positive and negative forms aloud.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich habe kein Auto.” mean?

- A. That is not expensive.
- B. I am not tired.
- C. I do not have a car.

2. What does “Das ist nicht teuer.” mean?

- A. That is not expensive.
- B. I am not tired.
- C. We do not have time.

3. What does “Ich bin nicht müde.” mean?

- A. We do not have time.
- B. I am not tired.
- C. I am not coming.

4. Complete: Das ist ____ teuer.

- A. kein
- B. keine
- C. nicht

5. How does Mia travel?

- A. By car
- B. By bus
- C. By plane

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - I do not have a car.

“Ich habe kein Auto.” means “I do not have a car.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - That is not expensive.

“Das ist nicht teuer.” means “That is not expensive.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - I am not tired.

“Ich bin nicht müde.” means “I am not tired.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. C - nicht

Teuer is an adjective, so negate it with nicht.

5. B - By bus

Mia says Ich fahre mit dem Bus.

One possible mission response

Ich habe kein Auto. Das ist nicht teuer. Ich bin nicht müde. Wir haben keine Zeit.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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